

Philipp Hilbert

PRODUCT MANAGER | PRODUCT OWNER

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PROFILE

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of product ownership across fintech, marketplace, payments, and regulated industries. I have built a P2P mobile payments product from zero through acquisition, owned marketplace trust mechanics, and actively trade across centralized and decentralized crypto venues. I run continuous discovery, turn strategy and user needs into a prioritized roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery.

HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
- On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
- Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
- I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder and Product Manager, construct8, Limassol | 12/2025-Present

Construction staffing. Two-sided B2B marketplace matching firms with workers.

- Built zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model protecting both sides until commitment, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface.
- LLM agents across the full funnel; one person runs the day-to-day. Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

Product Manager, Rohde & Schwarz, Munich / Remote | 07/2024-05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Managed a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum; instrumented two competing workflows and redirected strategy, increasing pipeline runs by 200%.
- Championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, cutting rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable.

Product Manager, Bundesagentur für Arbeit, Nuremberg / Remote | 05/2023-07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline, introduced Dagster and dbt, and cut time per data update by ~75%.
- Carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration in parallel while migrating a bare-metal system fully into containers.

Product Owner, CLINET Platforms, Berlin | 01/2023-07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android.

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into KIS workflows, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

Product Manager, EMIL Group, Berlin | 04/2022-12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, brokers, and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from a near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

Product Owner Integration Team, Scheidt & Bachmann, Mönchengladbach | 09/2021-03/2022

Retail and payments, POS and forecourt systems. Full SAFe setup.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation with agile release trains and PI planning.

Product Owner (interim), Bundesdruckerei, Berlin | 03/2021-06/2021

Government. Secure data platform for the Robert Koch Institute (DIM and DESH).

- Owned data structures and identity management for national health reporting infrastructure.

Product Owner (proxy), AOK ITSCare, Frankfurt | 03/2019-05/2020

Health insurance. B2B e-commerce procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

FOUNDER TRACK

Co-Founder and Product Owner, Qcrypt AG, Berlin | 01/2016-12/2021

IT security. Quantum-secure encryption hardware and software.

- Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes, unblocking enterprise buyers. Later Chair of the board.

Co-Founder, CDO and CFO, Smart Soil Technologies, Berlin | 03/2018-08/2021

Nanotechnology and agriculture. Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds.

Founder and CFO, Kvitt Payment Solutions, Berlin | 02/2013-11/2018

Fintech. Mobile group-based P2P payments product, built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

- Owned the full product: matching, escrow mechanics, payment flows, dispute handling, and trust model between users.

SKILLS

- **Product Ownership:** requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.
- **Product Management:** continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP and PoC definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support.
- **Fintech and Payments:** P2P payments, fintech platform design, payment flow UX, escrow mechanics, dispute resolution, trust and safety, fraud prevention, girocard ecosystem.
- **Web3 and Crypto:** CEX/DEX mechanics, perpetual futures, AMMs, cross-chain bridging, DEX aggregation, stablecoins, crypto data analysis (Coinglass, Hyblock Capital); 8+ years as an active crypto user and trader across Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, 1inch, Across Protocol.
- **Analytics and Data:** funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.
- **Agile and Scaled Delivery:** Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAgile, ART, PI planning.
- **Technical Environments:** Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.
- **AI Products and Tooling:** LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, n8n.
- **Governance:** GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

EDUCATION

Diplom-Wirtschaftsingenieur (Industrial Engineering and Management, equivalent to a Master's degree), Technische Universität Berlin (TU Berlin), Germany | 10/2006-09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)